

HCI researcher (PhD candidate) specializing in the design and evaluation of interactive systems that support how groups of people work together. Over five years of end-to-end research—from framework development and rapid prototyping to controlled lab studies and field evaluations with teams—published and presented at top HCI venues (ACM CSCW/PACMHCI, DIS, CHI, NordiCHI). Skilled at translating technical concepts across multidisciplinary teams of researchers, designers, and engineers. Seeking to extend this work to human–AI interaction, building and evaluating generative-AI tools that adapt to both individuals and the team as a whole.

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate, Industrial Design

Eindhoven University of Technology

Eindhoven, NL

Advisors: Prof. Berry Eggen, Dr. Harm van Essen · Focus: Designing & evaluating interactive systems for collaboration in hybrid work

M.A. in Design

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Shanghai, CN

Advisor: Assoc. Prof. Dong Zhanxun, Interaction Design Lab

B.Eng. in Industrial Design

Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Shanghai, CN

Exchange: *Hong Kong Polytechnic University* · Second major: English Literature

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Liu, L., van Essen, H., & Eggen, B. (2025). [What's Happening in the Office: Designing Information Displays for Human-Like Experience to Promote Workspace Awareness in Hybrid Work](#). *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)*, 9(7), 1–29.

Liu, L., van Essen, H., & Eggen, B. (2024). [Let Information Flow Into Awareness: A Design Space for Human-Like Experiences to Promote Informal Communication for Hybrid Work](#). In *Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS)* (pp. 1666–1680).

Xu, Y., Liu, L., & van Essen, H. (2025). [LiteCo: Illuminating Workspace Awareness and Social Connectedness with Ambient Display in Home Office](#). In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (pp. 1–8).

Liu, L., Wu, T., Cmentowski, S., Hu, J., & Bernhaupt, R. (2026). [When Chairs Speak: Interpreting Postural Cues as Social Signals in Hybrid Work](#). In *Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS Companion '26)*, Singapore. ACM, 7 pages.

Liu, L., van Essen, H., & Eggen, B. (2022). [An Exploratory Study of How to Design Interventions to Support Informal Communication in Remote Work](#). In *Nordic Human-Computer Interaction Conference (NordiCHI)* (pp. 1–10).

Lu Liu, Harm Van Essen, & Berry Eggen (2025). [Design Exploration of Lightweight Interactions for Awareness-Supporting Technologies in Hybrid Work](#). In *IASDR 2025: Design Next*, Taiwan.

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher

Eindhoven University of Technology | Industrial Design

Sept 2019 – Present

Eindhoven, NL

- Designed and deployed an awareness system to support collaboration across distributed teams; evaluated it with 20 participants across 5 teams using mixed methods—quantitative measures (questionnaires) and qualitative methods (semi-structured interviews, speculative workshops)—to assess impact on team communication; results submitted to ACM TOCHI.
- Built three interactive display prototypes and evaluated them in a controlled lab study with 24 participants, using a tangible Likert scale for interactive interviews to probe user experience; published in ACM CSCW.
- Developed a reusable design-space framework for awareness technologies in collaborative hybrid work through literature reviews, exploratory interviews, co-design workshops, and rapid prototyping; published at ACM DIS and IASDR.
- Conducted interviews with 10 knowledge workers worldwide to investigate communication challenges in remote, team-based work; published at ACM NordiCHI.
- Collaborated within a multidisciplinary group of researchers, designers, and engineers, and communicated research findings to academic and non-technical audiences; supervised multiple student research and graduation projects.

UX Design Intern

SAP

Dec 2016 – June 2017

Shanghai, CN

- Designed user flows and interfaces for the CRM module of SAP Anywhere, a web-based business management platform.
- Developed cross-team design guidelines to improve design consistency and efficiency across product teams.

UX Researcher

Hanssem Korea | Contract Research

Apr 2016 – Sept 2016

Shanghai, CN

- Conducted contextual inquiries and in-home interviews with single-person households in Shanghai, analyzing the relationship between living environments and user behavior.
- Delivered a comprehensive research report combining secondary data analysis (census data) and primary qualitative insights to define user segments and inform product strategy.

Previous Internships

Netease Games (UI & Game Design) · BBH London (Digital Design) · Lenovo Mobile (Graphic Design)

2014 – 2017

SKILLS

Research & Evaluation: Study design, controlled lab & field studies, interviews, co-design workshops, speculative design, survey design & analysis, heuristic evaluation, mixed-methods evaluation frameworks

Software & Prototyping: Python, HTML/CSS/JS, Raspberry Pi programming, rapid prototyping of interactive systems, Adobe Creative Suite

Analysis: Thematic & narrative analysis, descriptive & inferential statistics (parametric tests)

Languages: Chinese (native), English (professional)